

UPSC

Batch: Prarambh 2026

Subject: Ancient
India

Lecture No.- 05

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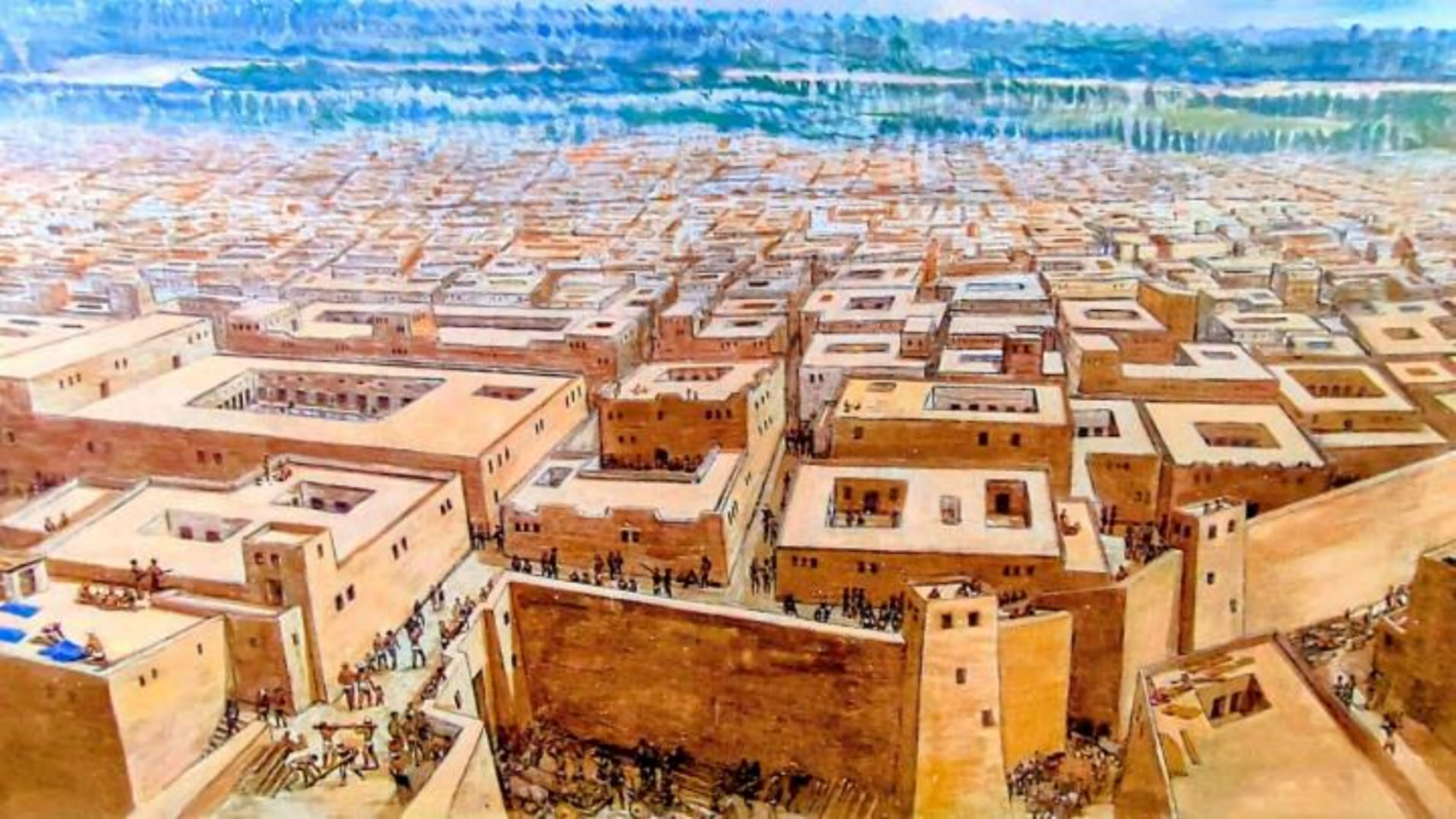
TOPICS TO BE COVERED

Indus Valley Civilization

↳ Discovery of Harappa

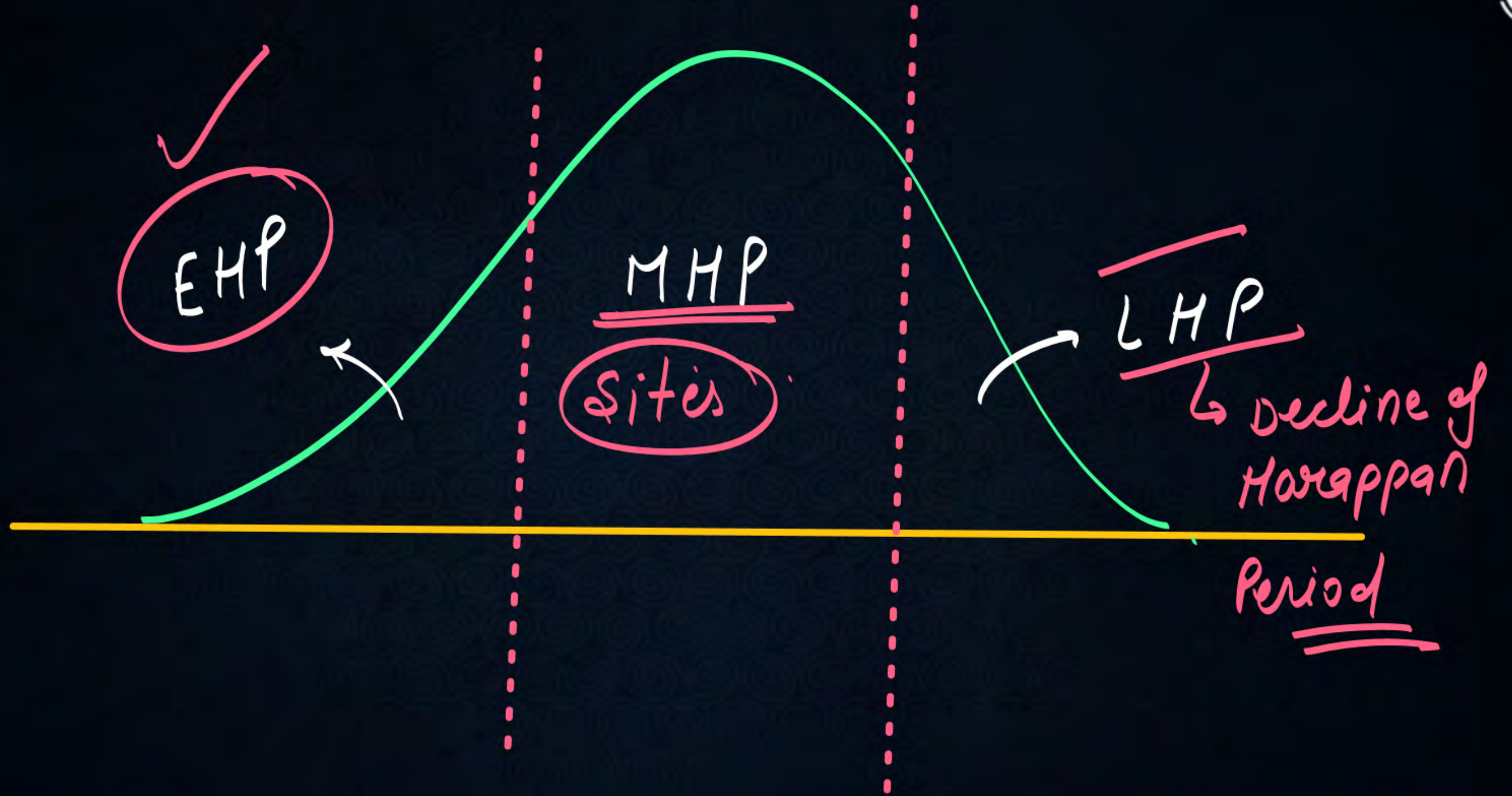
↳ Timeline

↳ Sites





MOHENJO DARO



Topic: Harappan

- ❑ **Location:** Montgomery district of Punjab (now in Pakistan).
- ❑ **Banks of River:** Ravi
- ❑ **Excavator:** Daya Ram Sahni (1921)
- ❑ **important Discoveries:**
 - **Two Rows of six Granaries:** It signifies storage of food, agriculture surplus, which is required for urbanized culture
 - **Brick Platforms for Agricultural Processing.**
 - **Citadel:** which signifies fortification, to control better, segregating rich from poor people.
 - **Single-Room Barracks:** Supposed to be occupied by Labour.
 - **Evidence of direct trade Interaction with Mesopotamia.**
 - **Post-cremotion burials** are more numerous.
 - **Working floors**
 - **Dice**
 - **Toys**
 - **Sculpture**

Topic: Harappan



Topic: Mohenjo-Daro ('Mount of the 'Dead')

- ❑ **Location: Pakistan (Sind)**
- ❑ **River: Indus**
- ❑ **Excavator: R.D. Banerji (1922), E. Mackay, Kashinath Dixit, Sir John Marshall (1930)**
- ❑ **Important Discoveries:**
 - It was a much bigger site than Harappa.
 - Multi-pillared assembly hall.
 - Great bath (a public venue)
 - College of priests (large building with several rooms and three verandas)
 - Large granary
 - Piece of woven cotton cloth
 - Illustrious town planning in a grid structure where roads and avenues meet at a right angle
 - The Great Bath: big swimming pool
 - Bronze dancing girl
 - Violent death of some inhabitants (discovery of human skeletons together)



Multi-pillared assembly hall







upper
city

lower city

river

1. Main Gate
2. Main Street
3. Cattle Bazaar
4. Market Square
5. Grainery Square
6. Shrine Front
7. Entry to Shrine
8. Arena
9. Upper City Gate
10. Mahan's House
11. Great Bath
12. Sewer
13. Lower Gate
14. North Gate

THE MAP OF MOHIENJO DARO



124

Topic: Mohenjo-Daro ('Mount of the 'Dead')



Topic: Mohenjo-Daro ('Mount of the 'Dead')





Topic: Mohenjo-Daro (Mount of the 'Dead')

❑ Important Discoveries:

- Seal representing Mother Goddess, Pasupathi, bearded man and a woman to be sacrificed.
- Evidence of ship/big boat.
- Bangles of clay
- Brick kilns ✓
- Seals of steatite
- Bull seal ✓
- Mesopotamian cylindrical seal
- Terracotta toys

❑ Magnificent town planning. ✓

❑ It was the most populated ✓

❑ It is given recognition by UNESCO as a World Heritage Site and funds are provided for its preservation.



Topic: Mohenjo-Daro (Mount of the 'Dead')

❖ Fortified Citadels:

- ❑ The town was divided into upper and lower towns with a distinctive citadel giving evidence for a place of residence for nobility. Such citadel can be seen in Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Kalibangan, etc.

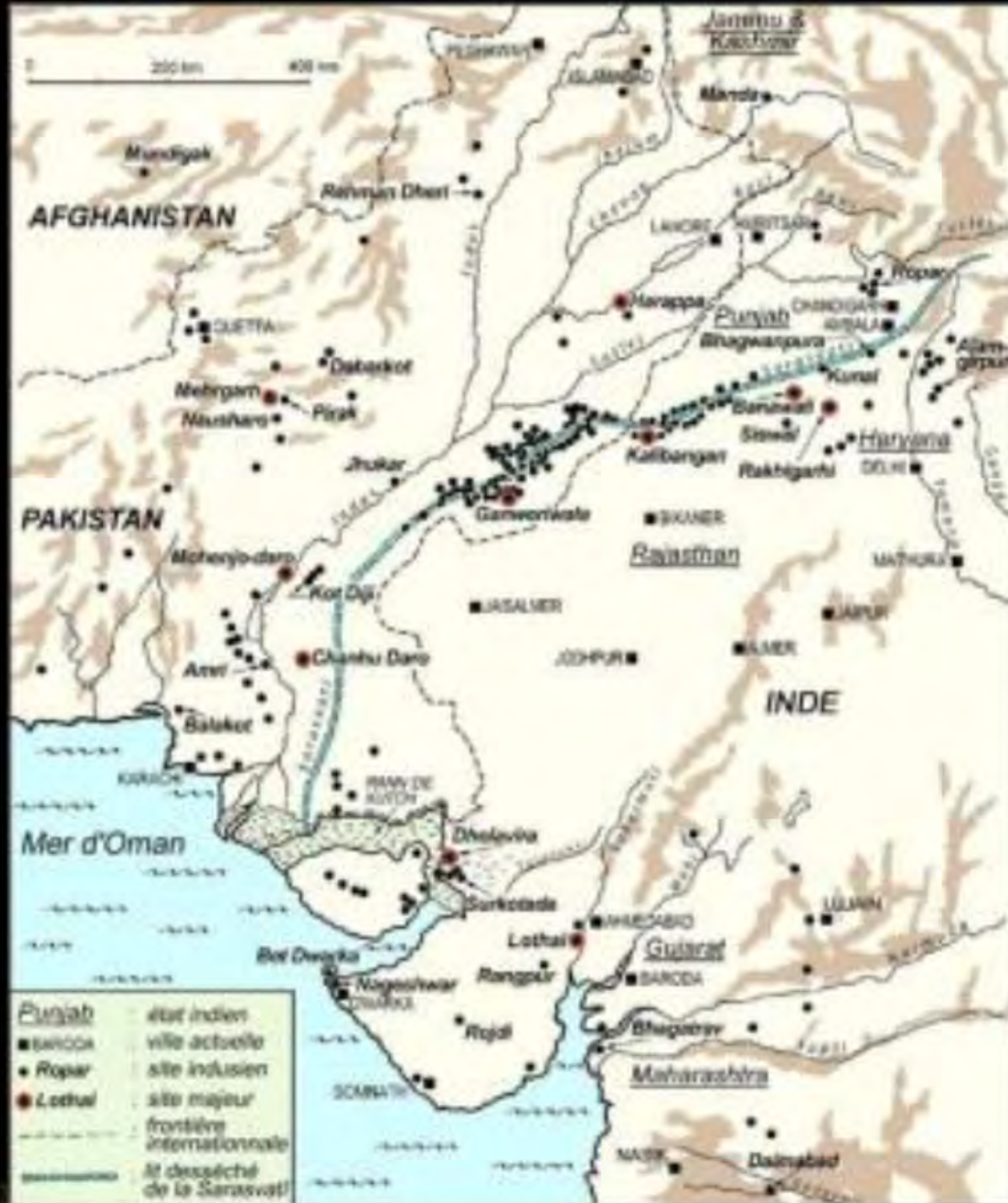


Topic: Chanhudaro

- ❑ **location** Pakistan (Sindh) near Mohenjo-Daro
- ❑ **River:** Indus River
- ❑ **Excavator:** N.G. Mazumdar (1931) and E. McKay.
- ❑ **Discoveries:**
 - **Bead factory:** This signifies that ornamentation was very important and there was mass production.
 - Another bead factory was at Lothal.
 - **No fortified structure:** Only Harappan city without a citadel.
 - Evidence of human sacrifice
 - Clay model of four-wheeler
 - Bronze model of roofed chariot.
 - Only stones and no bries were used.
 - **Inkpot:** This signifies that there was writing.
 - **lipstick:** It signifies that there was some kind of fashion.
 - Terracotta model of bullock cart.
 - Bronze toy cart.
 - Remains of both pre-Harappan and Mature Harappan culture.



Topic: Chanhu-Daro



Topic: Kalibangan ('Black Bangles')

- ❑ **Location:** Rajasthan (Ganganagar) near Ghaggar river.
- ❑ **Discovery:**
 - **Plowed Field:** Biggest cultivated land in entire pre-historic period, deep furrowed field. No discovery of plough, only grooves were discovered.
 - Chalcolithic was neither having plough nor hoe.
 - Fire altars showing practice of cult of sacrifice.
 - Bones of camels.
 - Not as well-planned and organized as Mohenjo-Daro. It did not even have a drainage system.
 - Burials in circular and rectangular graves are sometimes brick chambered.
 - Bangles and beads were also found.
 - Paved floors (Tiles to lay down smooth floor)
 - Provides evidence of pre-Harappan civilisation at the lower layer of excavation and mature Harappan. at the upper layer of excavation.
 - Decorative bricks used in flooring only at this site.

Topic: Kalibangan ('Black Bangles')



Topic: Kalibangan ('Black Bangles')



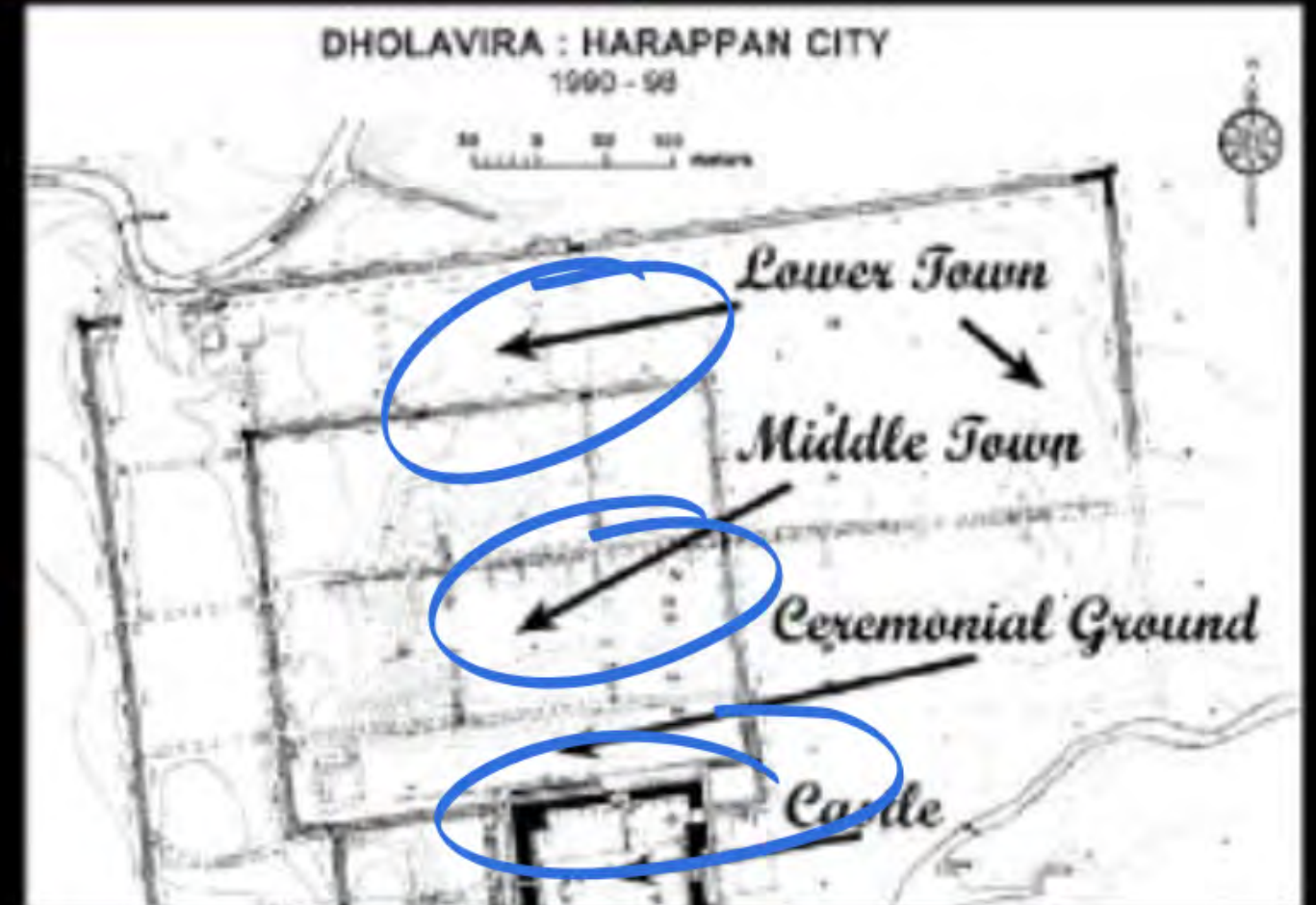
Topic: Surkotada

- ❑ Location: Bhuji, Gujarat.
- ❑ Discovered by J.P. Joshi in 1964,
- ❑ Discoveries:
 - Bones of horses (Debatable)
 - Oval graves
 - May be active in trade.



Topic: Dholavira

- ❑ **Bank of River: Luni** ✓
- ❑ **Excavated by: J.P. Joshi in 1990-91.**
- ❑ **Discovery:**
 - Giant water reservoir. ✓
 - Unique water harvesting system. ✓
 - Inscription/signboard.
 - Diagram of a chariot drawn by a naked human pulled by a pair of bullocks.
 - **Town planning**
 - **Gateway Entrance.** ✓
 - **Fortified Middle Town.** ✓
 - It had a large open space for ceremonies.
 - It was divided into three parts.
 - It was surrounded by massive stone walls.



Topic: Dholavira



Giant water reservoir

Topic: Dholavira

- ❖ **UNESCO World Heritage Site (included in 2021):**
 - ❑ The ancient city of Dholavira is one of the most remarkable and well-preserved urban settlements in South Asia, dating from the 3rd to mid-2nd millennium BCE.
 - ❑ Discovered in 1968, the site is set apart by its unique characteristics, such as its water management system, multi-layered defensive mechanisms, extensive use of stone in construction, and special burial structures.
 - ❑ Of note is also the art associated with the city – artifacts of various kinds, such as copper, shell, stone, jewelry of semi-precious stones, terracotta, gold, ivory have been found at the site.
 - ❑ In addition, the interregional trade links associated with Dholavira, have also been acknowledged as contributing to the shared heritage of humanity.

Topic: lothal

- ❑ location: Gujarat (Ahmedabad District, at the head of Gulf of Comboy)
- ❑ River: Bhogava and Sabarmati river confluence
- ❑ Excavator: S.R. Rao (1957)
- ❑ Discovery:
 - Dockyard
 - Well-planned wall city ✓
 - Centre of sea trade ✓
 - Important sea trade center
 - Bead-making factory ✓
 - Six sectors and each section was built on a wide platform
 - Houses with entrances on the main street
 - Rice husks ✓
 - Double burial male + female
 - Fire altar (was also found in Kalibangan)
 - Terracotta model of ship



Dockyard

Topic: lothal



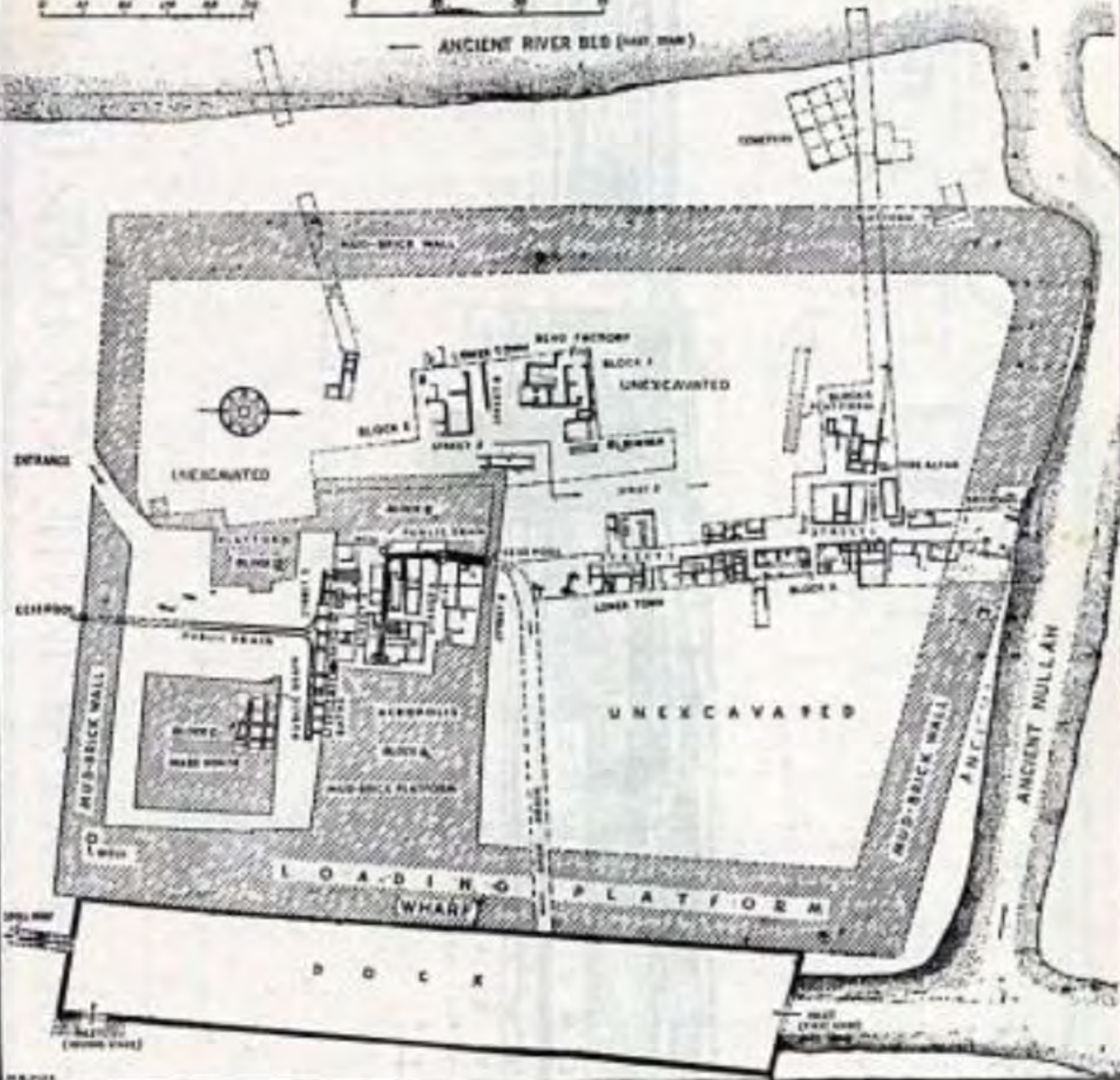
LOTHAL, TOWN PLAN

FEET
0 40 80 120 160 200

METRES
0 20 40 60 80

REFERENCE
 ■ MUD-BRICK PLATFORM
 □ MUD-BRICK HOUSES
 ■ BURNED-BRICK STRATUM
 --- DESIGN LINE
 --- DIRECTED ALIGNMENT

ANCIENT RIVER BED (HAY, 1904)



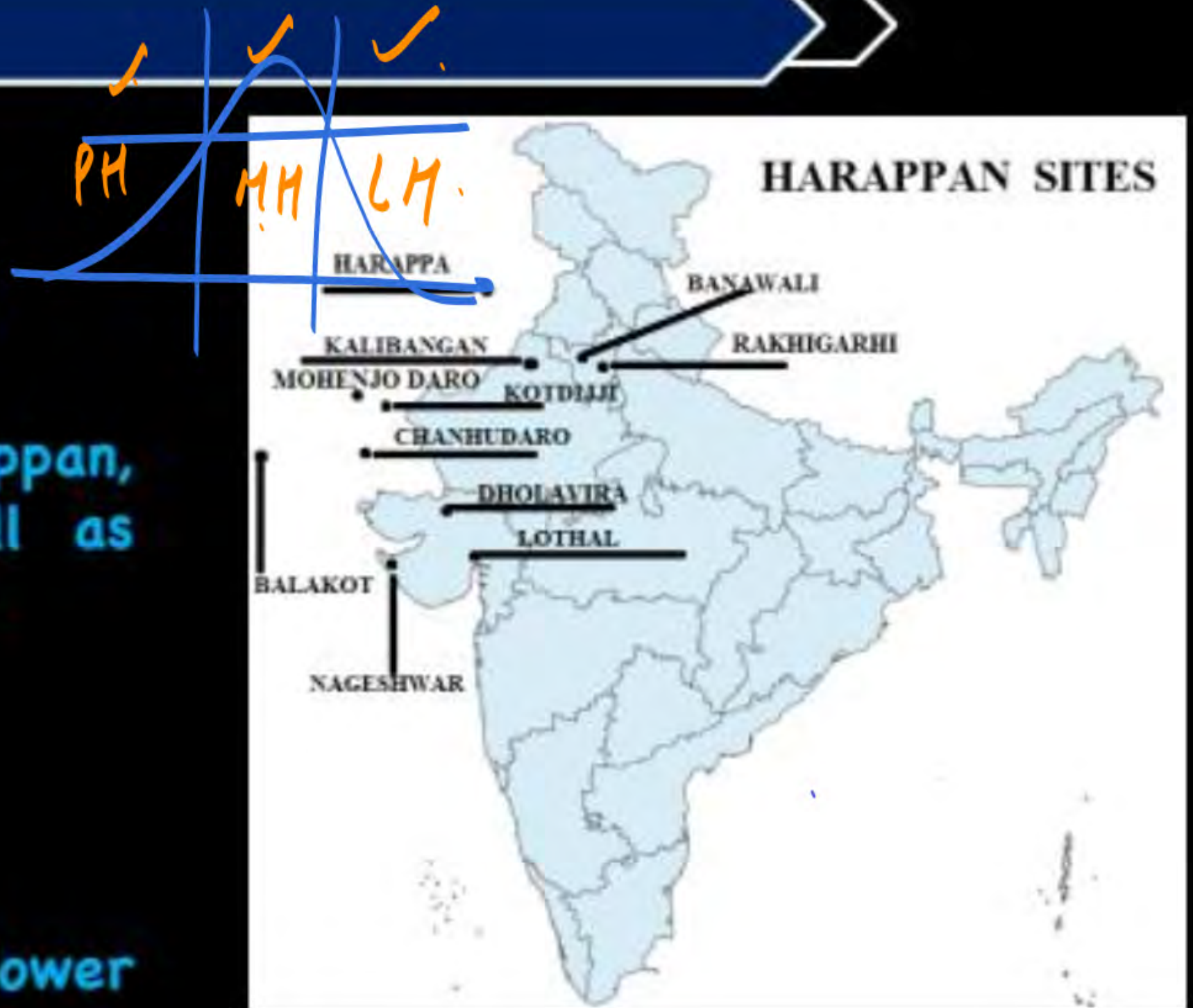
Topic: Rangpur, Gujarat (near Lothol)

- ❑ **River: Madar river**
- ❑ **Excavator: M.S. Vats (1931), S.R. Rao (1953-1954)**
- ❑ **Discovery:**
 - **Remains of both pre-Harappan and Mature Harappan culture.**
 - **Flakes**
 - **Yellow and gray color pots of pre-Harappan people.**



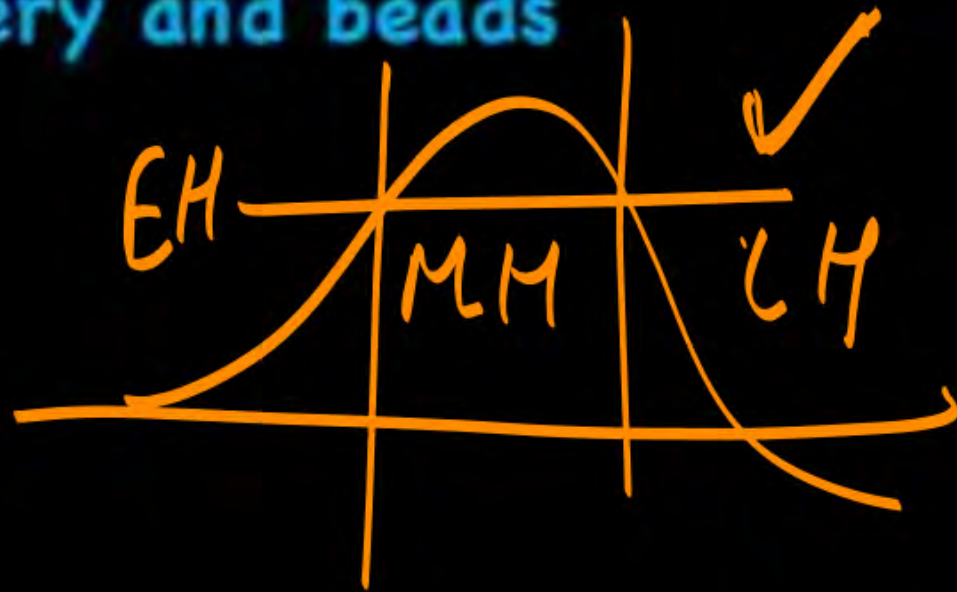
Topic: Banawali

- ☐ **Location:** Hissar, Haryana
- ☐ **River:** Rangoi ✓
- ☐ **Excavator:** R.S. Bist (1973-74)
- ☐ **Discovery:**
 - Centre of pre-Harappan, Mature Harappan as well as Late Harappan civilisation.
 - High quality barley
 - Ceramics, steatite seal
 - Fire altars
 - Clay model of plough
 - Seals, found only in lower town and not in citadel



Topic: Alamgirpur

- ❑ location: Meerut (Uttar Pradesh)
- ❑ River: Hindon River ✓
- ❑ Excavator: Y.D. Sharma (1958)
- ❑ Discovery:
 - Late-Harappan culture
 - Impression of cloth on a trou
 - Pottery and beads



Topic: Koti-Diji

- ❑ location: Sindh (Pakistan)
- ❑ River: Sindh river
- ❑ Excavator: Ghurey (1835), Fazal Ahmed (1955)
- ❑ Discovery:
 - Pre-Harappan site
 - House-made of stone
 - City-destroyed by force

✓
~~EH MH LH~~



Topic: Amri Sindh

- ❑ **River: Sindh River**
- ❑ **Excavator: Ghurey (1835) Fazal Ahmed (1955)**
- ❑ **Discovery:**
 - Remains of Rhinoceros



Topic: Ropar

- ❑ location: Punjab, India. ✓
- ❑ River: Sutlej river ✓
- ❑ Excavator: By Y.D. Sharma (1955-1956)
- ❑ Discovery:
 - Cemetery. ✓
 - Seal earthen pot. ✓
 - Buildings mainly of stone and soil. ✓
 - Evidence of burying the dog below the human. ✓



Topic: Suktagendor

- ❑ location: Balochistan, Sindh (Pakistan)
- ❑ River: Dasht/ Dashak river.
- ❑ Excavator: A Stein, George Dales.
- ❑ Discovery:
 - Ash filled pot
 - Copper axe
 - Earthen bangles and pottery
 - Originally a port hut later cut off from sea due to coastal uplift
 - Had trade links with Babylon.



Topic: Rakhigarhi

- ❑ Location: Near Hisar, Haryana
- ❑ Largest Indus valley Civilisation site
- ❑ Shows all three phases of IVC.
- ❑ World's largest museum of Harappan culture to be set up in Haryana's Rakhigarhi village.



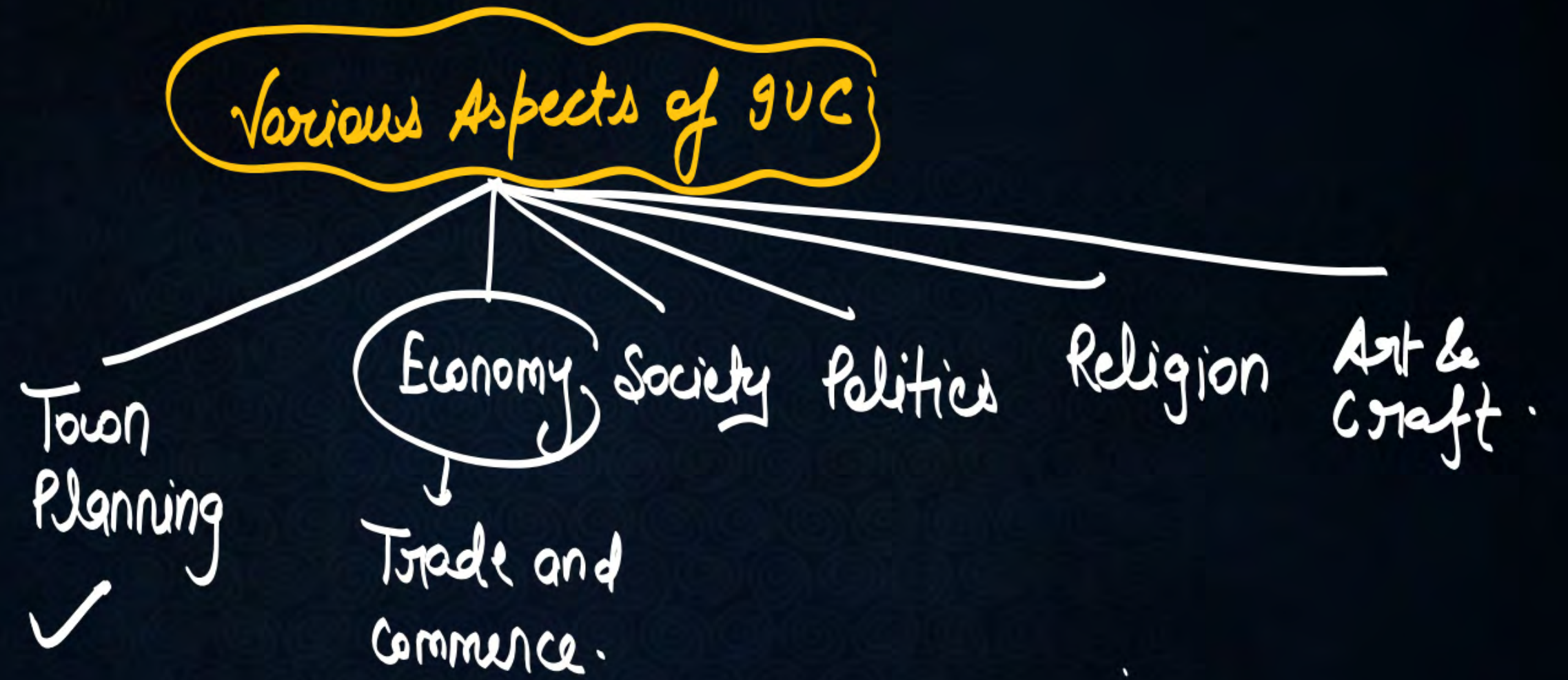
Topic: Bhirrana (Fatehgarh)

- ❑ A fragmented artifact of a thick ✓
- ❑ Sturdy red ware with an incised female figure - 'dancing girl' has been discovered.



Topic: Important Facts

-
- Hand-drawn diagram of a 3D coordinate system with axes labeled EM, LH, and MH. A curved arrow points from the origin to the EM axis, and another curved arrow points from the origin to the LH axis. The text "P3E" and "H019P39" is written near the origin.



● Harappan civilization was an urban civilization, Do you Agree?

↳ V. Gordon Childe Neolithic Revolution
Urban Revolution → Major transformation
↳ that mark an impact on every aspect of life.

How to define a city → Foreign Trade.

- ↳ Must be more extensive than previous settlement
- ↳ Dense population
- ↳ Specialization in work — craftsmanship, Traders, Priest etc
- ↳ Monumental Architecture.
- ↳ Ruling class — that used to collect taxes
- ↳ knowledge of writing — communication

● GVC as an Urban Centre:

- ↳ Magnificent Town Planning.
- ↳ Division of city — Citadel and lower city
 - ↳ Fortified.
- ↳ System of Road and Sanitation.
 - ↳ Covered drainage system
 - ↳ Every house connected to drainage system
- ↳ Evidence of Foreign Trade
- ↳ Script of GVC — Not deciphered yet.
- ↳ Best art and craft — seals and Pottery.

● City Planning / Urban Planning:

↳ Division of city → Upper Town / Citadel and lower town.

↳ Raised Part
↳ Fortified

↳ with working class quarters

↳ Grid Plan: Arrangement of Houses, Roads and drainage

↳ at some distance - River.

↳ Cutting at right Angle on 90°

↳ Rectangular Block.

↳ Main road is 10 meter wide.

↳ Lamp Post

↳ Rounded corners.

Houses: Burnt Bricks were used

↳ Ratio - 1:2:4 / $7 \times 14 \times 28$ cm (Brick Size).

↳ Uniformity - common planning - some authority.

↳ In Egypt only dried Bricks were used

↳ People of Mesopotamia - used Burnt Bricks

↳ But on much smaller scale

} IVC was much Advanced
in comparison to Egypt
or Mesopotamia.

↳ Presence of two or more storey Building.

↳ No window at main street - Privacy

↳ Rooms around a courtyard



- ↳ No gates on main street
- ↳ Roofs made of mud or wood
- ↳ Specific places to throw garbage
- ↳ No Pottery kilns in city
- ↳ Few houses were larger while other were smaller — shows social inequality.

Drainage System

- ↳ Wells in house as well as Public wells.
- ↳ Bathroom in houses were connected to small drainage.
- ↳ Small drainage was connected to main drainage.
 - ↳ Drains were covered.
 - ↳ Gentle slope —
 - ↳ Made of mortar lime or gypsum
 - ↳ Inspection manholes for cleaning.

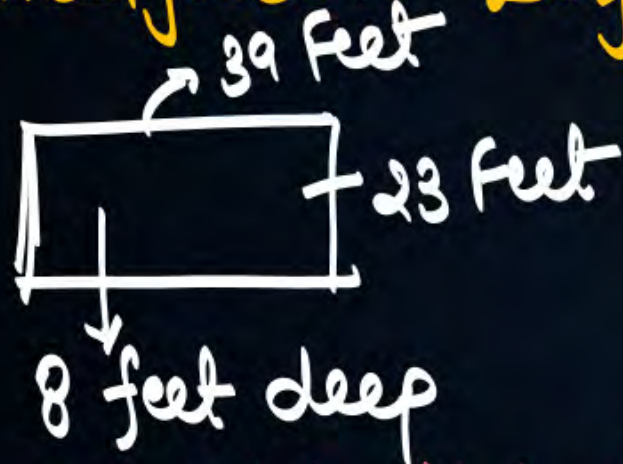
City Planning

Public Buildings

The Great Bath

↳ found in Mohenjodaro - Large swimming pool.

Size



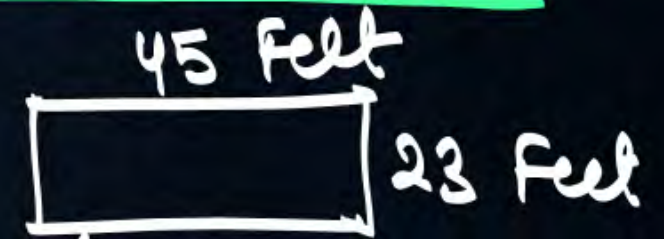
↳ Plastered - Inlet/outlet of water.

↳ Surrounded by rooms

↳ Presence of flight of steps.

The Great Granary

Size



↳ Great Granary - largest structure at Mohenjodaro.

↳ 2 Rows of six granaries at Harappa.

Topic: V. Gordon Childe (1892-1957)

- ❑ An Australian social evolutionist and archaeologist.
- ❑ Pioneer and influential theorist on major transformations in human society's development.
- ❑ Introduced the concepts of the **Neolithic Revolution** and the **Urban Revolution** to understand urbanism.
 - Used the term 'revolution' to compare these major social transformations of prehistory with the Industrial Revolution.
 - Emphasized that these changes affected all aspects of human life and should be understood as such.
 - Utilized data from excavations at Ur in the 1920s.
 - Acknowledged **defining 'city' as extremely hard**.
 - Presented the city historically as a symbol and outcome of a revolution, marking a new economic stage.



Topic: V. Gordon Childe (1892-1957)

- ❑ **The Urban Revolution, in the Town Planning Review in 1950:**
 - In terms of size, the first cities must have been more extensive and densely populated than the previous settlements.
 - The urban population differed from any village or town in composition and function as here we find **full-time specialist craftsmen, merchants officials, traders and priests**.
 - Every producer, even the most primary ones, had to pay tax on the small surplus that was obtained with limited technical equipment. **This tax was paid to a divine king or an imaginary deity who collected all the surplus.**
 - Monumental architecture distinguishes cities from villages and also fulfills **the symbolic role of the concentration of social surplus.**
 - A major share of the concentrated surplus was retained by a few who formed **the "ruling class"**. This group included priests, administrative officials and civil and military leaders.

Topic: V. Gordon, Childe (1892-1957)

- **The Urban Revolution, in the Town Planning Review in 1950:**
 - The invention and use of writing for administrative and communication purposes.
 - The elaboration of sciences like **geometry, arithmetic and astronomy.**
 - Production of sophisticated styles of art.
 - **Foreign trade over long distances.**
 - A state organization that was now based on residence and not kinship.

Topic: V. Gordon Childe (1892-1957)

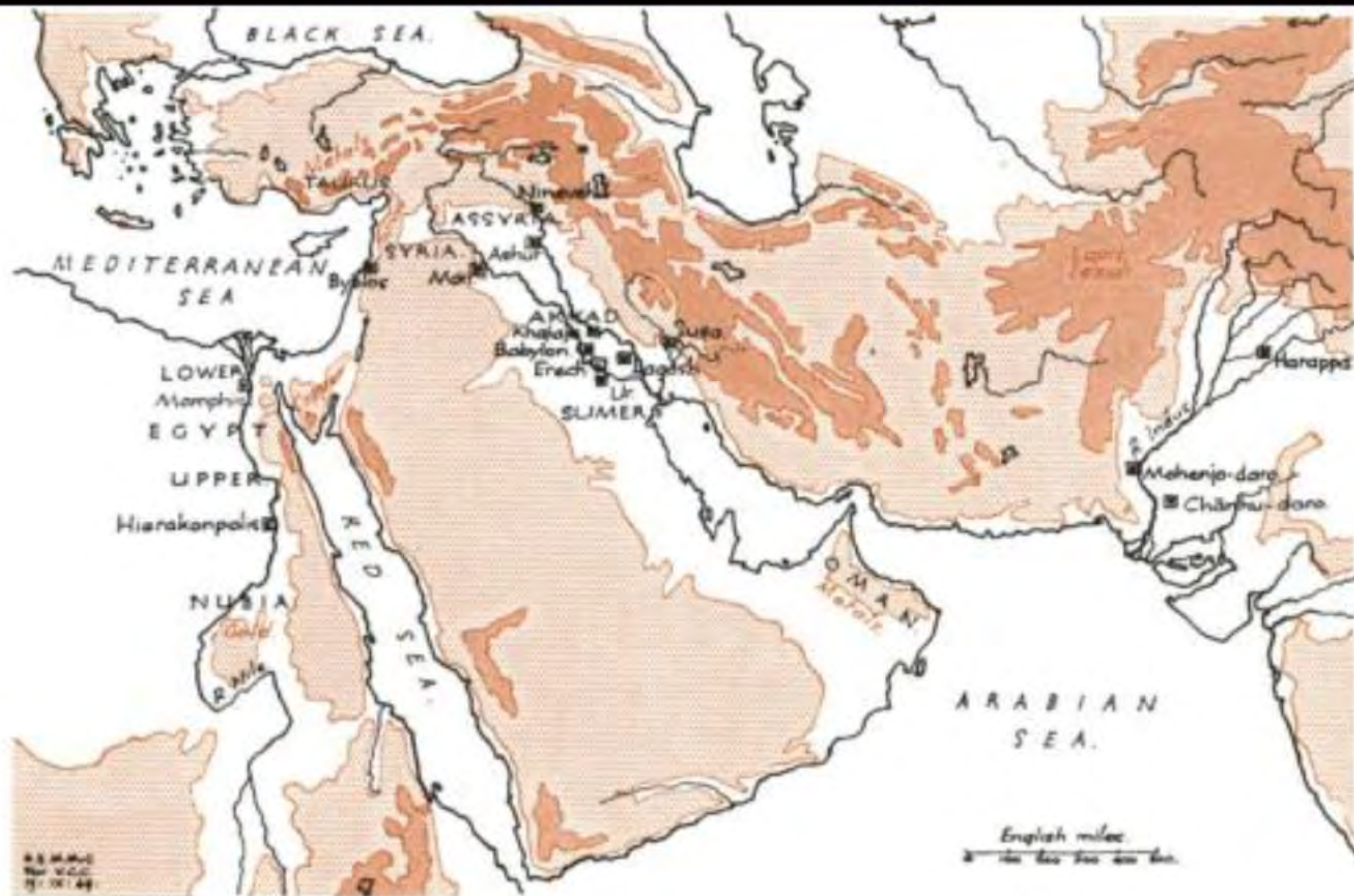


Fig. 10—First Centres of Urban Civilization in the Old World

Topic: Urban Culture

❖ Features:

- ❑ Magnificent town planning.
- ❑ Homogenisation: Raised part (Citadel) with fortifications.
- ❑ Presence of Roads and Sanitation.
- ❑ Covered Drainage system with instructions.
- ❑ Every house was connected to the drainage system.
- ❑ Dedicated space for dumping the garbage.
- ❑ Public wells or personal wells were present.
- ❑ Discovery of Double-storied houses, burnt-bricks, bathroom, a kitchen and a well Public Buildings in the Citadel
- ❑ Presence of Great Bath, Granaries and Assembly Halls.



Topic: Urban Culture

❖ Villages to Cities:

- ❑ Cities grew out of earlier villages.
- ❑ Before 2600 B.C. cities like Harappa, Dholavira, Rakhigarhi, Banawali, Kalibangan, Rehman Dheri, Nausharo, Kot Diji and many more existed in the form of rural Harappan settlements.

❖ Town Planning:

- ❑ City divided into two parts:
 - Citadel (Upper Part/Raised Part), with fortification (generally in the western direction), on the raised platform.
 - lower Part (working-class quarters).
 - After the lower town, at some distance, there was riverine.
- ❑ **Presence of Grid plan:** It followed in arrangement of houses, and roads and lanes cutting across one another almost at **right angles** thus dividing the city into several rectangular blocks.

Topic: Urban Culture

❖ Roads/Streets wide:

- ❑ Intersected at right angles.
- ❑ Main street was 10 m wide
- ❑ Lamp-posts were present.
- ❑ Corners were rounded.



Topic: Urban Culture

❖ Bricks:

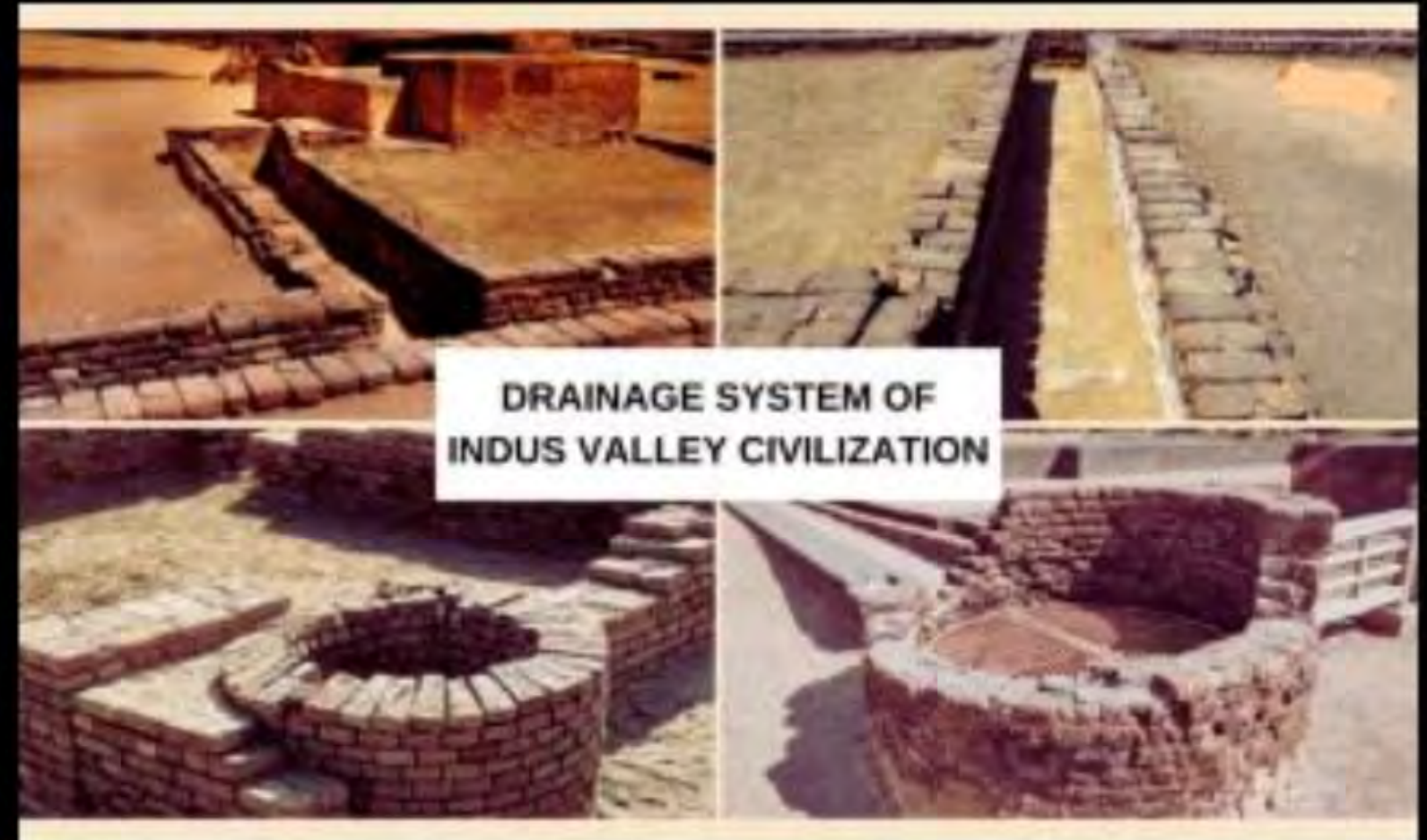
- ❑ Usage of Burnt bricks.
- ❑ Identical ratio of bricks: 1:2:4 [thickness:width:length].
- ❑ Uniformity in size of bricks Houses: 7 x 14 x 28 cm.
- ❑ It shows that there is some kind of common planning which is ensuring that the same types of bricks should be created in order to maintain uniformity in the whole Indus Valley Civilization.
- ❑ In Egypt, dry bricks were used (shows that we were much more advanced than Egypt).
- ❑ In Mesopotamia, burnt bricks were used at a much smaller scale.



Topic: Urban Culture

❖ Drainage System:

- ❑ Drains were covered.
- ❑ Usage of bricks or stone slabs.
- ❑ Inspection holes/Manholes were present (which could be removed for cleaning).
- ❑ Gentle slope connected to house drains.
- ❑ Drains were made of mortar, lime and gypsum.

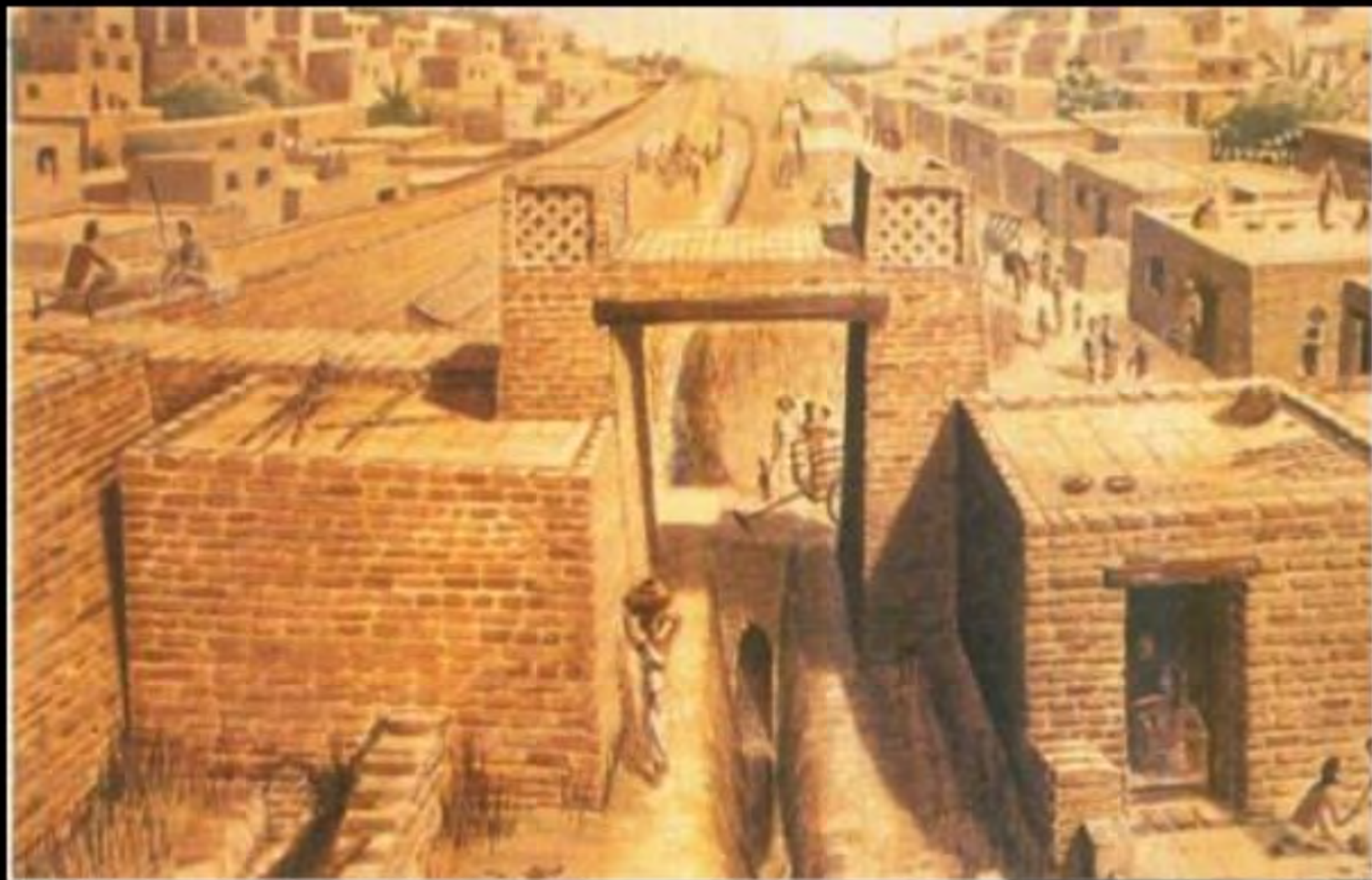


Topic: Urban Culture

❖ Houses:

- ☐ Presence of two or more storeys.
- ☐ Staircases were tiled.
- ☐ Bathrooms were connected to common drainage.
- ☐ Presence of personal wells.
- ☐ No window laced the streets (indicated privacy)
- ☐ Houses were 1/2 storey high.
- ☐ Rooms were around the courtyard.
- ☐ Main door did not open on the main street.
- ☐ Rooms had paved floors.
- ☐ Roofs were made of mud, reed and wood.
- ☐ Presence of watch and ward arrangement.
- ☐ Presence of specific places to throw rubbish and waste materials.
- ☐ Public wells were present in every street.
- ☐ Pottery kilns were not allowed within the town.
- ☐ Some barrack-like groups of single roomed tenements at Mohenjo-daro and Harappa were similar to the coolie lines of Indian tea and other estates.
- ☐ Some big houses whereas other small ones show some kind of social inequality.

Topic: Urban Culture



Topic: Urban Culture

❖ Public Buildings:

- ❑ A high pillared hall area 80 sq. ft Assembly hall

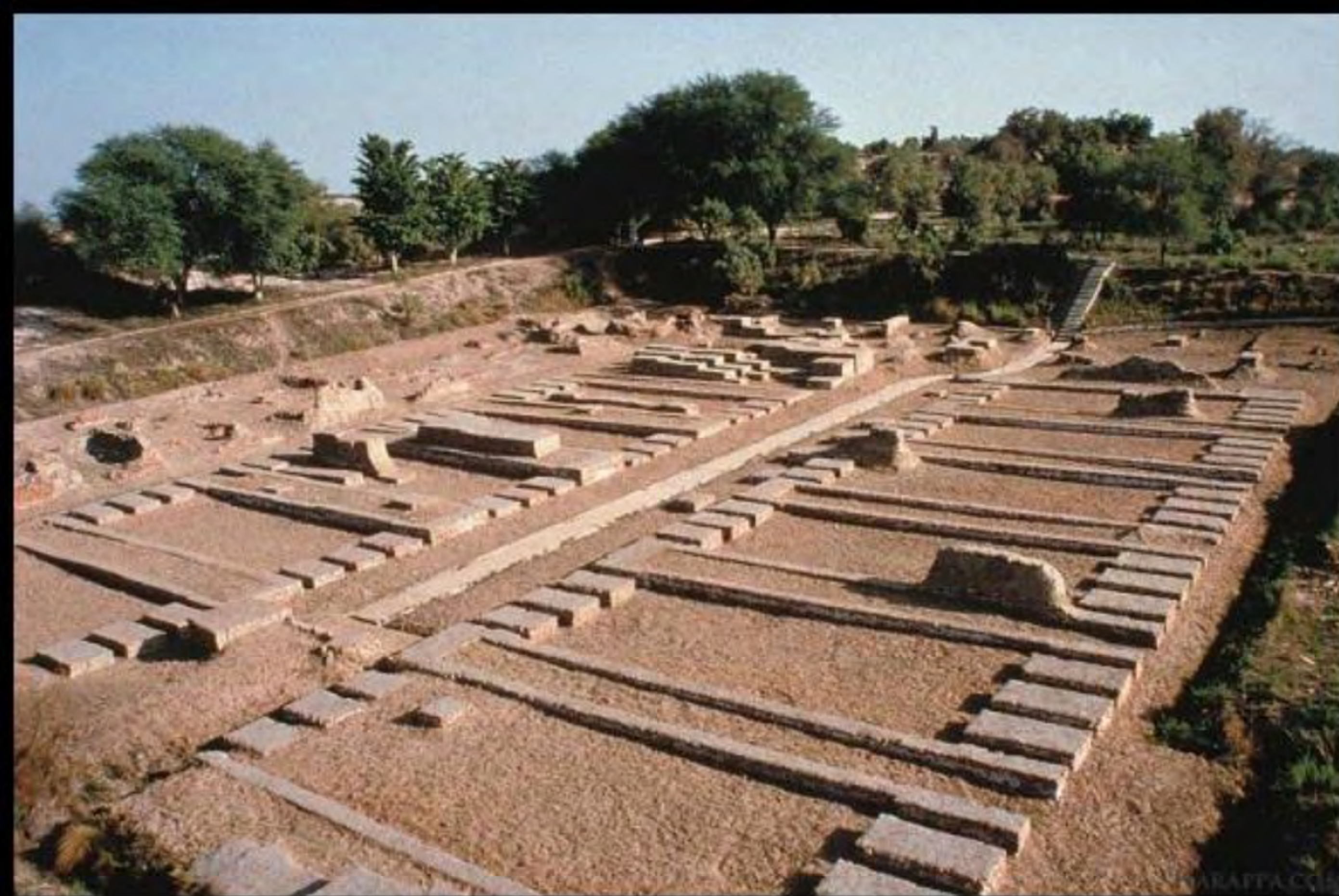
❖ Great Bath:

- ❑ It is made up of a big quadrangle.
- ❑ Large swimming pool in the center (39 feet long, 23 feet wide, and 8 feet deep).
- ❑ It was about 180 ft X 180 ft sq.
- ❑ **There exist Bricked lining**
- ❑ **It was Plastered**
- ❑ **Bricks 20 in. X 8 in. & 9 X 4**
- ❑ **It was watertight with tar to prevent water leakage**
- ❑ **There was a system of inlet/outlet of water**
- ❑ **It was surrounded by rooms**
- ❑ **Presence of flight of steps**
- ❑ **It was fed by a well situated adjoining room**



Topic: Great Granary

- ❑ The largest building at Mohenjodaro is the granary, which measures 45.71 meters in length and 15.23 meters in width.
- ❑ Two rows of six granaries each were built on a set of brick platforms that were present in Harappa.
- ❑ Further subdivided into smaller storage blocks.
- ❑ **Granary at Harappa:**
 - 6 Granaries.
 - Smaller and measure 15m X 6m
 - Working floors: rows of circular brick platforms arranged in rows.
 - Used for threshing grains.
 - A two-room barrack.



Great Granary

Topic: Cultural Template

- Whole civilization was having an affinity towards squares which can be seen in IVC architecture.



THANKS
